



**CASE STUDY: STRANGLER PATTERN AT BLACKBOARD LEARN (2011)**

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## **TEXTBOOK: THE DEVOPS HANDBOOK 2ND. ED - CHAPTER 13**

### **Case Study: Strangler Pattern at Blackboard Learn (2011)**

Chapter 13 of The DevOps Handbook focuses on how organizations can make software releases safer, faster, and less risky. The case study showed that instead of replacing an entire legacy system at once, companies can improve their systems gradually over time. This allows them to continue supporting customers while still making important updates and improvements. One of the main ideas discussed in the chapter is the "Strangler Pattern." This approach allows teams to slowly replace parts of an old system with new components rather than attempting a large and risky migration all at once. By making small changes over time, organizations can reduce the chance of failures and avoid major disruptions to the business.

The authors also explained the value of testing new ideas on a small scale before implementing them across the entire organization. Techniques such as feature flags and dark launches allow developers to release code into production while controlling who can see or use new features. This makes it easier to identify problems early and fix them before they affect customers.

The biggest lesson from this chapter is that small, incremental changes are usually more successful than large, complex projects. Organizations that build systems designed for frequent and low-risk deployments are able to deliver improvements faster while maintaining reliability and stability. Overall, the chapter demonstrates that successful DevOps practices are built on continuous improvement, automation, and reducing risk whenever possible.